POST-MARKETING FOLLOW-UP OF PRODUCTS

Function:	Prepared by:	Reviewed by:	Approved by:
Department:	Quality Assurance	Systems and cybersecurity	Quality Assurance
Name:	Iván Pérez	David Pozo	Fernando Pozo
Signature:			
Date:			

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1. Target

The purpose of this procedure is to describe how the post-marketing management of medical devices supplied by Spika Tech, hereinafter referred to as SPIKA, is carried out.

As set out in Regulation 2017/745 on medical devices, the post-market surveillance system should be adequate to actively and systematically collect, retain and analyse relevant data on the quality, performance and safety of a device throughout its life cycle, to draw relevant conclusions and to identify, implement and monitor any preventive and corrective actions.

2. Outreach

This procedure applies to all medical devices supplied by SPIKA.

3. Responsibilities and Departments concerned

Department	Applies	
	Yes	No
Address	☒	☐
Environment	☒	☐
Quality Assurance	☒	☐
Systems and Cybersecurity	☒	☐
Research and Development	☒	☐
Marketing and Sales	☒	☐
Management	☒	☐

4. Definitions and Acronyms

- Medical device (MD): any instrument, device, equipment, software, implant, reagent, material or other article intended by the manufacturer to be used on humans, separately or in combination, for any of the following specific medical purposes:
  - diagnosis, prevention, monitoring, prediction, prognosis, treatment or alleviation of a disease,
  - diagnosis, follow-up, treatment, relief or compensation for an injury or disability,
  - investigation, replacement or modification of the anatomy or of a physiological or pathological process or state,
  - information obtained by in vitro examination of samples derived from the human body, including organ, blood and tissue donations, and which does not exert its intended primary action within or on the surface of the human body by pharmacological, immunological or metabolic mechanisms, but to whose function such mechanisms may contribute.
- Medical device vigilance system: The Medical Devices Vigilance System refers to the reporting of adverse incidents involving medical devices, their recording and evaluation, the adoption of appropriate measures for health protection and the transmission of these measures to the actors concerned.
- Incident: Any malfunction or deterioration of the characteristics or performance of a marketed product, including errors of use due to ergonomic features, as well as any inadequacy of the information provided by the manufacturer or any undesirable side effects.
- Serious Incident: To report an incident, it must be associated with a medical device or with the information provided with the medical device and the incident must be such that it has resulted in death or serious deterioration in health, or if it occurs again it may cause death or serious deterioration in health.

  The types of adverse incidents to be reported are as follows:

  1. Those resulting in death

2. Those resulting in a serious deterioration of the patient's, user's or other person's state of health, such as, for example:

a) Life-threatening illness or injury

b) Permanent impairment of a bodily function or permanent damage to a bodily structure

c) A process that requires medical or surgical intervention to prevent permanent impairment of a bodily function or permanent damage to a bodily structure.

3. Potential incidents, which are those that could have resulted in death or serious deterioration of health, but did not occur due to either fortunate circumstances or the intervention of healthcare personnel.

5. Procedure

5.1. Introduction and generalities

SPIKA as a Manufacturer shall comply with the requirements on vigilance of medical devices as laid down in the applicable legislation in force for Class IIa products of which it is the manufacturer.

Information on adverse incidents related to medical devices manufactured by SPIKA may come from:

- Healthcare professionals, directly or through any employee of SPIKA or service providers contracted by SPIKA
- Patients, users or private healthcare professionals, directly or through any employee of SPIKA or companies subcontracted by SPIKA.
- Companies with which SPIKA has marketing agreements
- Health regulatory authorities

If such information is received, a complaint report will be processed according to SOP-007 Complaint Handling and the causes, consequences and corrective actions to be implemented, if necessary, will be investigated.

A post-marketing monitoring plan is drawn up at SPIKA that will collect the following information:

- Information relating to serious incidents, managed through SOP-007 Complaints Handling
- Records concerning non-serious incidents or data on undesirable effects of the product
- Information on trend reports
- Relevant bibliography, databases and/or specialist or technical records
- Information, including feedback and complaints from users, distributors and importers´
- Public information on similar medical devices

This monitoring plan includes proactive and systematic searches to collect all the information mentioned above to characterise the product's performance and compare it with similar products already on the market.

5.2. Incident management and reporting to health authorities

SPIKA shall manage reported incidents through SOP-007 Complaint Handling, as soon as an incident is detected, an initial report shall be sent to the competent national authority where the incident occurred.

Incidents categorised as serious will be reported to the authorities. Products manufactured by SPIKA are Class IIa, however, they will be monitored and any notification will be made using the MIR Manufacturer Incident Report for Serious incidents and Incidents form, search for its current version on the Internet (MIR 7.3.1 Helptext).

The Responsible Technician will be in charge of communications with the Health Authorities.

5.3. Communication deadlines

SPIKA is obliged to report a confirmed serious incident immediately after causality of the incident to the product has been established or it has been established that such a causal relationship is reasonably possible, and no later than 15 days after becoming aware of the incident.

Incomplete preliminary reports can be submitted followed by the full report.

5.4. Monitoring and reporting plan

SPIKA undertakes to produce a report every six months with the following content:

- Information relating to serious incidents, managed through **SOP-007 Complaint Management,** shall list the complaints received indicating root cause and associated CAPAs, as well as whether they are associated with surveillance incidents or are quality defects.
- Records concerning non-serious incidents or data on undesirable effects of the product
- Information relating to trend reports,
- Relevant bibliography, databases and/or specialised or technical records will be searched:
  - Information Notes that may be published on the websites of the Health Authorities for medical devices (EMA and AEMPS) and the WHO.
  - Safety-relevant publications on PubMed (http://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pubmed/) will be reviewed to be alert for possible incidents.
- Information, including comments and complaints from users, distributors and importers'.
- Public information on similar medical devices

With all the data collected in the post-market monitoring report SPIKA will be able to:

- *improving benefit-risk assessment and risk management*
- *update information on design and manufacture, instructions for use and labelling*
- *updating the clinical assessment*
- *update the clinical safety and performance summary*
- *identify needs for preventive, corrective or safety corrective actions*
- *identify possibilities for improving the use, performance and safety of the product*
- *contribute, where appropriate, to post-market monitoring of other products*
- *spotting and reporting trends*

The information gathered in these reports will allow us to verify the consistency of the product in terms of safety, efficacy and quality, highlighting possible trends and allowing us to clearly identify the improvements to be implemented, constantly evaluating the risk benefit, the manufacturing process and therefore the quality of the final product. The frequency of this report may be increased if in two successive reports no potential risks or hazards related to the product are found by increasing the frequency of the report by a further six months, e.g.

after two six-monthly reports with no potential risks, the report shall be carried out every year and so on.

In doing so, the updating of the technical documentation of the product shall be carried out where applicable. Likewise, where necessary, corrective actions shall be notified to the competent authorities concerned.

6. Distribution of the Procedure

Staff belonging to the departments listed in Section 3 (Responsibilities and Departments concerned) should be provided with a copy of this procedure. In addition, controlled copy no. 1 will be given to the Archives for archiving on paper.

Controlled copies to be issued:

No. Controlled copy	Departments
1	Archive

7. Annexes

NUMBER / REV.	TITLE
N/A	N/A

8. Related documentation

Code	TITLE
MQ-01	Quality Manual
PNT-007	Complaints management
N/A	MEDDEV 2.12 Guidelines on a medical devices vigilance system

9. Training

This version requires the following training for the departments concerned as indicated in paragraph 3:

Mark with an X	Type of training
☒	**Theoretical** (reading and understanding of the procedure)
☐	**Theoretical - Practical** (If this option is selected, please contact the Technician in charge).